

A Sound Solution

Q I have a Pinnacle PCTV Rave TV-Tuner, and my computer has Windows XP Pro SP2. I want to record TV programs in WMV, DivX, as well as the MPEG-2 formats, but the software provided with the card does not support it. I have tried to use third-party PVR programs such as InterVideo WinDVR, but it does not capture sound.

Ajay Tiwari

A The Pinnacle PCTV Rave TV Tuner encodes TV audio right on the board, and there is no loop-through cable that goes to the line-in of the sound board, as is usually the case with most TV-Tuners. That's why the audio does not work with InterVideo WinDVR, since it does not feature an option to use internal TV audio. There are some programs such as ChrisTV from www.chris-tv.com and BeyondTV from www.snapstream.com that support such TV-Tuners (with on-board audio chips) and also allow you to capture in the WMV, DivX, and MPEG-2 formats.

Anti vs. Anti!

Q I had installed McAfee AntiVirus from your CD for a trial run, then uninstalled it and returned to my older Norton AntiVirus. The problem is that Windows Security Center says I have the above two antivirus programs running.

Paramjeet Singh

A Right-click on My Computer and click Manage. Expand Services and Applications and click on Services. Find the Windows Management Instrumentation service, right-click it, and choose Stop. Open My Computer, then go to (assuming Windows is installed on C) C:\Windows\System32\WBEM\Repository. Delete it. Return to the Windows services screen; find Windows Management Instrumentation, right-click on it, and choose Start. Restarting this service will rebuild the repository folder information. Restart your computer. Windows Security Center should be fine.

Video's Not On The Cards

Q I have an NVIDIA GeForce FX 5200 graphics card. The problem is that the display goes blank after entering Windows, even when I have installed the official WHQL drivers. When I booted using my onboard graphics, I got a message that read something like "the display device driver was unable to complete a drawing operation. Please check for a driver update." I downloaded the latest drivers from NVIDIA, but the problem persists. My PC configuration is an AMD Athlon XP 2100+ CPU and 512 MB DDR RAM on an ASUS A7N266VM motherboard and I have Windows XP Professional SP2.

Vinay Chaudhary

A A device driver conflict seems to be at play. Here's what you can do: Boot your system while using the onboard video card, then uninstall all the video card drivers. If possible, use System Restore to get back to a time when the computer was working fine, and then uninstall the display drivers. Now, reboot and get to the BIOS. Go to the Advanced Options, and look for the PCI display menu. Under VGA BIOS, change

the adapter to AGP VGA. Save the settings, shut down the computer, and install the new video card. Reboot and install the display drivers. Your issue should be resolved. Alternatively, start the machine in Safe Mode; right-click on My Computer and select Properties > Hardware > Device Manager and expand the Display adapters option. Right-click on each entry under display adapters, and select Uninstall. It is imperative that you install only the latest drivers for the motherboard, and also to ensure that your BIOS is up to date. Check at the motherboard manufacturer's Web site for this.

The Un-dead!

Q I uninstalled a program, but the Add/Remove Programs applet still shows the entry for it. So how do I get rid of it?

Akhilesh Srivastav



A Open the Registry Editor and navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall. You can find the entries related to the uninstalled program in the right pane. Just delete them.

Installing An Installer!

Q I have Windows XP. I get the Windows Update Error 0x80070420 while trying to update Windows.

Irfan Sheikh

A First, Check to see if you have Windows Installer 3.1 installed: go to Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs, search the list of programs for Windows Installer 3.1. If you find it there, uninstall it, then reboot and install the program; if it's not there, you're fine; just install it. The program (Windows Installer 3.1) is at <http://www.microsoft.com/downloads/details.aspx?familyid=889482fc-5f56-4a38-b838-de776fd4138c&displaylang=en>. Reboot and then try and do the Windows Update. ☐